

Miralam Akbarli

Overview

What is my professional aspiration?

Snapshot of last 7 months:

JEM'ing since September 2025 in Ministry of Agriculture, Digital and AI transformation project in a 1+1 setup.

What are my goals at the Firm for the next 6–18 months?

- Build on **my experience JEM'ing a major public-sector transformation since September 2025** and continue stepping up on broader leadership responsibilities

What excites me?

- Moving work **from strategy and planning into implementation and public launch**
- Building trusted thought-partner relationships with senior clients
- Playing an active role in **coaching colleagues, recruiting talent, and contributing to office-building efforts**

What are my strengths?

- **Manages Work/Projects:** Strong ownership of delivery , prioritization, and stakeholder alignment across complex AI programs
- **Counsels Clients / Builds Relationships:** Trusted thought partner to senior stakeholders, including regular engagement with the Deputy Minister and senior ministry leadership
- **Apprentices Others / Enriches Firm Talent:** Active in coaching colleagues, shaping team structures, and contributing to recruiting and office culture
- **Communicates Effectively:** Strong in developing clear, decision-ready materials for senior audiences across complex topics

What office/Firm contributions energize me the most?

- Supporting recruiting and helping **identify strong talent for the office**
- Turning project **work into reusable knowledge for the Firm through PDs**

How have I contributed to strengthening our Firm this year?

As I Work Toward My Aspiration And Reflect On Previous Development Conversations, How Am I Developing The Relevant Skills And Growing?

Manages Work/Projects

- Since **September 2025**, have been **JEM'ing** the project, owning the full delivery rhythm across the program while leading **1 BA internally** and a **15+ person multidisciplinary client-side team** including PMO, **4–5 data scientists**, agronomists, biologists, and tech leadership; this created a stable execution model across implementation, value creation, and monetization
- Managed integration planning across the full **33-use-case** portfolio with the vendor, pushing for faster execution and clearer sequencing; this helped move **10+ use cases** to integration-ready status and established a practical path for delivery through the rest of the year
- Led delivery of **Farmer Scoring** and **Crop Variety** through integration to public launch, making **2 use cases** available to **300k+ farmers**; this turned the program into a visible delivery success rather than a roadmap-only effort
- **Built an updated agile team structure with clearer expert involvement, KPIs, and performance-tracking mechanisms**; this increased accountability within the team **and gave the project a more scalable operating model as scope expanded**

Solves Problems

- Built a monetization case with **20 Mn AZN annual value** and presented it directly to the Minister; this clarified the economic upside of the program and **received positive feedback from both the Minister and Deputy Minister**
- Worked with senior ministry stakeholders on **Crop plowing use case** and its potential implications for **subsidy policy**; this connected a **technical use case to a broader policy with meaningful client relevance**

Counsels Clients

- Led planning and senior alignment for **33 use cases** targeted for year-end delivery, presenting priorities and sequencing directly to the **Minister and Deputy Minister**; this created a single leadership-backed roadmap for implementation and **fixed the confusion on the use case alignment**
- Worked with the **Deputy Minister on a weekly basis** as a thought partner on priorities, progress, and decision topics, while managing the client project manager day to day; this helped maintain **senior stakeholder confidence and kept the project aligned with leadership expectations**

Communicates Effectively

- Led the team in producing weekly steering documents for senior client leadership and managed **5+ Minister-level meeting packs** involving internal and external stakeholders; this improved decision quality and increased visibility on **progress and bottlenecks across the program**
- Prepared materials presenting project results to the **Ministries of Economy and Finance** and the **Presidential Administration**; this broadened support for the program beyond the core client team and included **positive feedback from the relevant Deputy Minister in the Ministry of Economy**

Builds Client Capabilities

- Led a **15+ person multidisciplinary client-side team** across implementation, value creation, and monetization topics; this strengthened the client team's ability to drive the program in a more coordinated and outcome-oriented way
- Arranged multiple trainings for the KTN AI team, including **Finance 101** and **Process Management Essentials**; this helped strengthen **team capability on core topics and received positive feedback from participant**
- Provided an Excel masterclass for the SDM PMO team; **this strengthened the team's practical analytical capability and received positive feedback from the client**

Demonstrates Entrepreneurship

- Led discussions on the next phase of the project, supported development of the **LOP**, proactively pushed for **agentic AI in the next phase, and organized a client workshop on future opportunities**; this helped shape follow-on work and expand the scope of impact

Builds Expertise

- Co-developed two PDs based on project work, **“Digital and AI Transformation in Agriculture”** and **“Remote Sensing in Agriculture, Market Research”**; this converted delivery experience into reusable Firm knowledge and strengthened the agriculture transformation proposition

Enriches Firm Talent

- Supported the Firm's recruiting efforts through **25+ HR interviews** and recently stepped up to **Round 1 interviews**, already completing **4+ interviews** in the new role; this expanded my contribution to talent selection and supported the office in identifying strong candidates
- Led the creation of the Baku office's signature artifact, **“Seeds of Impact,”** from design through delivery; it was selected to represent the office at the **Partner event**, giving the office a distinctive and high-visibility way to showcase its identity and contributions

Upholds Values

- Served as an active member of the **Experience Council**, staying regularly connected with **3+ teams** to monitor team experience and help ensure work-life balance was being maintained; this strengthened team health and helped surface experience issues early
- Balanced **a demanding delivery agenda with attention to team sustainability**, using regular check-ins and feedback sessions to keep performance high **without losing sight of how the team was operating day to day**

Who are my mentors/sponsors at the Firm?

Sinan K., Murat G., Ugur Cem Y., Gozde K., Cem A., Manolya Y., Ercan B., Mecit N., Nijat J., Oguzcan Y.

Looking Ahead**Demonstrates Entrepreneurship**

- Continue shaping **next-phase opportunities in KTN**, including **agentic AI and adjacent topics**

Builds Client Capabilities

- Continue becoming more active in **building client capabilities in digital and AI transformations, especially in implementation-heavy settings**

What support do I need from my mentors/sponsors and the Firm?

- Feedback on how to continue **strengthening my leadership style as I move further into manager-level responsibilities**

Will this plan give me energy and how can I make it sustainable for me, both personally and professionally?

Yes. The work gives me energy because it combines leadership, visible client impact, problem solving, and colleague development

[Optional] Additional Considerations

What are the top 3 topics, if any, I would like to discuss with my DGL?